

Framework Formulation for Standard vs Bespoke Data Products

A workshop-first approach for defining the standards that separate reusable, scalable data products from one-off bespoke delivery.

Page 1: core standards workshop

Standard architecture + practices

Decision baseline for all later steps

Core premise

Step 1 is the crucial step and should be treated as the foundation of the whole effort. The outcome is a shared standards baseline that later steps operationalize.

If the standard is unclear, every downstream prioritization, discovery, and ADO delivery decision becomes unstable.

1

Identify Standards — Subject of Workshop

Define what “standard” means before selecting, scoring, or delivering products.

Definition of “standard”

Agree the reusable components and boundaries that qualify a product as standard.

- Shared Lakehouse?
- Shared semantic model?
- Shared reporting layout?
- Reference Mike’s standards definition document, if available.

High-level standard architecture

Use the architecture baseline, including Sol Arch's diagram, to anchor technical consistency.

- Source to ingestion path
- Lakehouse / curated layer
- Semantic and consumption layer

Domains covered

Identify which business or analytical domains are in scope for standardization.

- Finance, CSAT, supply, sales, HR, etc.
- Cross-client applicability
- Domain ownership expectations

Data product types

Clarify which deliverable forms can be standardized.

- Power BI report
- Output table
- CSV or extract
- Reusable semantic model

Potential standard products

Create the candidate list that can later be shortlisted into base products.

- Known repeatable reporting needs
- Existing bespoke products with reuse potential
- Domain-level candidate inventory

Standard processes and practices

Document how standard delivery differs from bespoke delivery.

- Process flows
- CI/CD expectations
- End-to-end solution management
- Governance and support model

Workshop Definition Lens

Reusable by design

Built once and adapted across clients or domains without restarting from zero.

Governed architecture

Uses approved patterns, shared layers, and consistent quality controls.

Operationally managed

Has clear ownership, pipeline, release, and support practices.

Standard Architecture Concept

Business Domain

Scope, owner, KPIs



Shared Data Layer

Lakehouse, curated tables



Standard Product

Power BI, semantic model, output table, CSV

Architecture detail should be aligned to SolArch's diagram. This visual is a placeholder framing for the infographic.

Operationalize the Identified Standards

Steps 2–5 translate the Step 1 standards baseline into shortlist selection, prioritization, discovery iteration, and ADO delivery structure.

Flexible after Step 1

DVF scoring

Discovery → ADO pipeline

How to use this page

This page is intentionally separate from the core standards workshop. The operating approach may change depending on the standards agreed in Step 1.

Treat Steps 2–5 as the execution model, not the definition of the standard itself.

From Candidate Standards to Delivery Pipeline

2

Identify possible base products

Use Step 1e as the shortlist and select the best base product per domain from the existing list.

3

Prioritize standard products

Apply DVF scoring to rank candidates by desirability, viability, and feasibility.

4

Discovery for standard products

Iterate from the selected base products and identify feature, process, practice, and architecture changes.

5

Standard products in ADO / Delivery pipeline

Decide what percentage of sprint capacity supports long-term standard-product goals versus bespoke demand.

Step 3: DVF Prioritization

Score Area	What to assess
Desirability	How many clients or domains need it? Is the business problem recurring?
Viability	Can it be owned, governed, supported, and evolved as a standard product?
Feasibility	Can the architecture, data availability, CI/CD, and delivery model support it?

Step 4: Discovery Inputs

Input	Role in discovery
Best judgement	Useful, but not ideal if used alone. Should be validated against evidence.
Similar bespoke reports	Compare and combine existing products to identify repeatable commonalities.
2+ client requirements	Use multiple-client needs to define high-level requirements for the standard product.

Step 5: ADO / Delivery Pipeline Structure

Create EPIC

Represent the long-term standard-product objective and link it to the agreed Step 1 standards baseline.

Create Features

Break the standard product into major capability areas, domain versions, architecture enablers, or process improvements.

Create User Stories

Translate discovery outcomes into sprint-ready backlog items with acceptance criteria and delivery evidence.

Capacity principle

Explicitly allocate sprint capacity between standard-product evolution and bespoke delivery.

Traceability principle

Every delivery item should trace back to a base product, DVF rationale, and discovery finding.

Iteration principle

Standard products evolve through repeated discovery and implementation cycles, not one-time design.

Overall Decision Flow

Phase	Primary question	Output
1. Identify standards	What makes a data product standard instead of bespoke?	Standards definition, architecture, domains, product types, candidate products, standard practices.
2. Identify base products	Which existing product is the best starting point per domain?	Base-product shortlist.
3. Prioritize	Which standard products should be pursued first?	DVF-ranked standard-product backlog.
4. Discover	What needs to change to make the base product a true standard?	Feature, process, practice, and architecture change set.
5. Deliver in ADO	How do we fund and manage standard-product work over time?	EPIC, Features, User Stories, and capacity allocation model.